

Social Stigma Against Working Women in Bangladesh: Between Career and Culture

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Overview*

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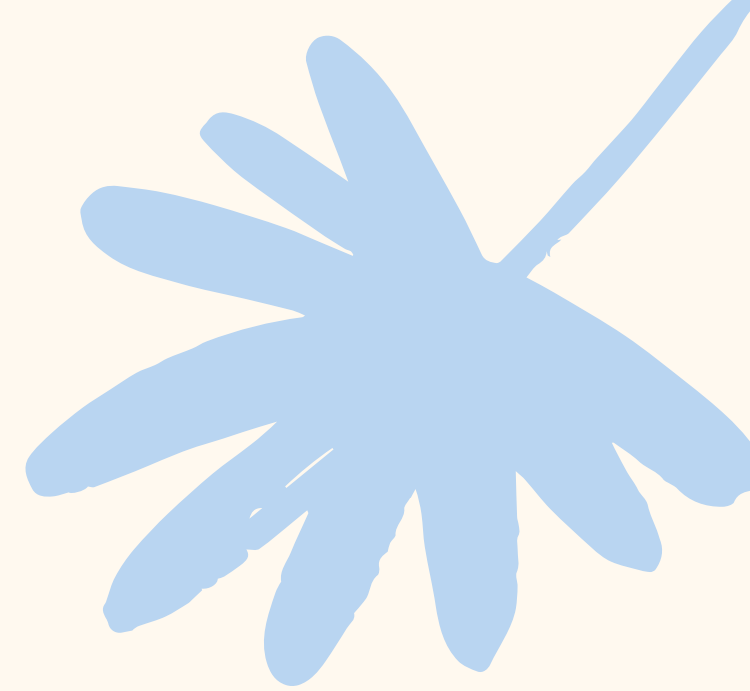


Introduction

Social stigma is defined as negative labels or judgments from society. In Bangladesh, women are often expected to remain as mothers or housewives. Even with more women entering the workforce, criticism and cultural pressure continue. Balancing **career vs. cultural expectations** becomes very difficult. This stigma reduces women's confidence, limits opportunities, and slows national growth.

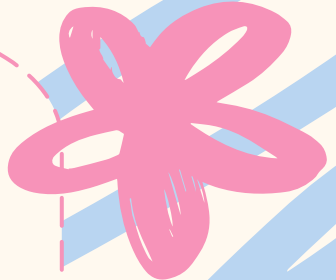


Rationale*



- Relevant as all researchers are women.
- It highlights gender inequality and workplace unfairness.
- Many women are judged just for working outside the home.
- In a developing country, women's workforce participation is essential.
- Studying this topic helps us understand why society must change its attitude.

Research Questions*

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- 1) How does social stigma affect working women in Bangladesh, especially when they try to balance career and culture?
 - 2) What are the common social attitudes toward women who work outside the home?
 - 3) What cultural beliefs make it harder for women to work after marriage or becoming a mother?



Methodology



In the methodology, a mixed-method approach was used.

Tools:

six structured questions was distributed through Google Form and Zoom interview was conducted .

Sampling:

Purposive, 5 participants (working students & working women).
Along with the survey, one interview was conducted.

finding from Articles

Researchers found five main challenges ([Ahmed et al., 2022](#)) :

- Family pressures
- poor workplace facilities
- unsupportive working environments
- social stigma
- sexual harassment

Global perspective ([Traylor et al., 2020](#)) :

- “Maternal wall” bias against mothers
- Gender norms limit women’s jobs



finding from Working Women-based Opinion

Women reported facing social stigma despite family support.

Issues included:

- Unfair treatment after maternity leave
- Missed promotions
- Seen as housewives, not professionals
- Struggles balancing family and work
- Gender-based violence and discrimination
- Judgment for late marriage & studying abroad.



Reflection of the Authors

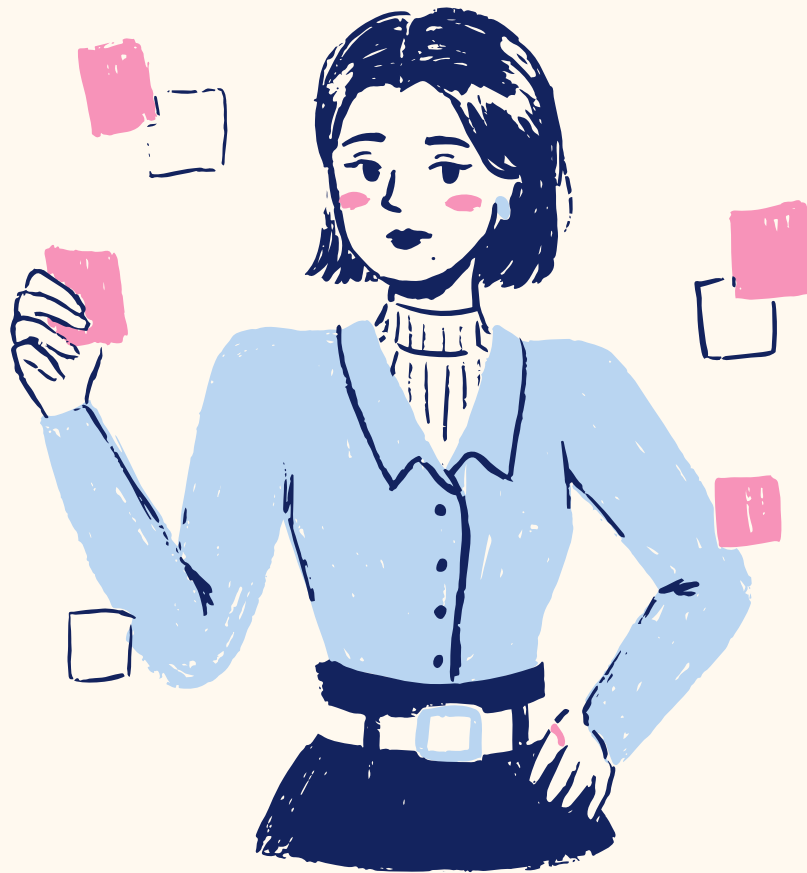
This research process showed that stigma is not an individual problem but a cultural and structural issue. Hearing participants' voices gave deeper insight. Society still measures women by traditional roles. This also has been discovered through this study that education plays an important role in changing mindsets. Education is the key for women to speak for themselves.



Limitations

The study faced some constraints:

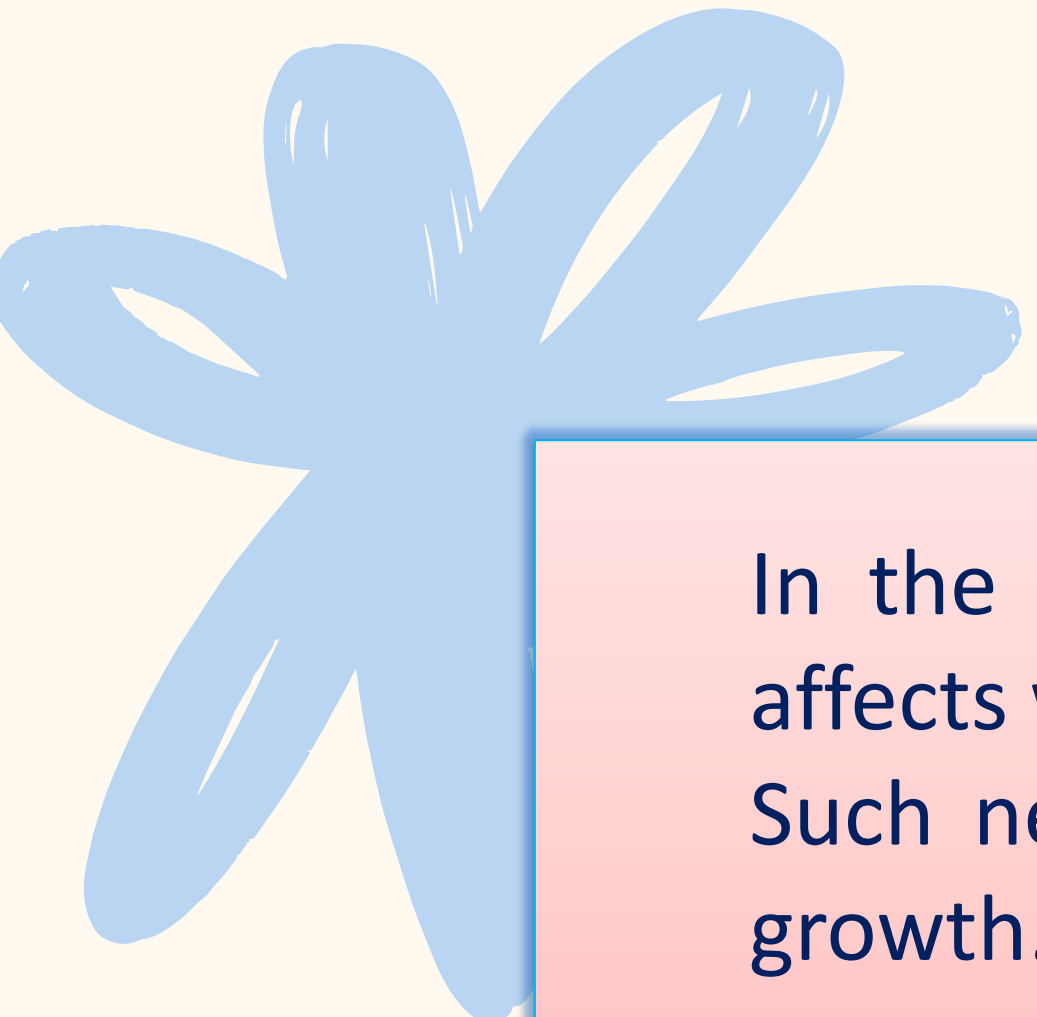
- Small sample size
- Limited time and resources
- No large-scale case studies



Recommendations

The study suggests:

- Raising awareness of gender equality
- Building supportive workplaces
- Enforcing strict policies against harassment & discrimination
- Promoting education to shift cultural mindsets



Conclusion

In the conclusion, the study highlights that stigma still affects working women. Such negative attitudes harm careers and slow national growth.

A call to action:

- Respect women's choices
 - Support work–life balance
 - Remove stigma → progress for women and Bangladesh
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Thank
You

